

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X

RYAN SANTA,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD DETECTIVE DAVID
MEJIA (RETIRED), SHIELD NO. 05679, NYPD
DETECTIVE BRIAN GREAGIE, SHIELD NO. 2435, and
NYPD POLICE OFFICERS JOHN AND JANE DOES
NUMBERS 1-10,

Defendants.

----- X

SUPPLEMENTAL
SUMMONS

Index No.: 520392/2023

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

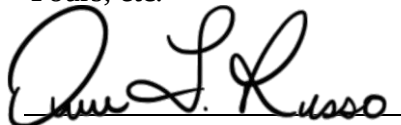
Plaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial.

To the above-named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
July 17, 2023

Yours, etc.



Omar T. Russo, Esq.
Shulman-Hill, PLLC
Attorneys for Plaintiff
1 State Street Plaza, 15th Floor
New York, New York 10004
(212) 221-1000

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, New York, New
York 10007

NYPD DETECTIVE DAVID MEJIA, Shield No. 05679, (RETIRED), 1 Police Plaza Path,
New York, New York 10038

NYPD DETECTIVE BRIAN GREAIKE, Shield No. 2435, Detective Squad, 32nd
Precinct, 250 West 135th Street, New York, New York 10030

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X

RYAN SANTA,

Plaintiff,

-against-

INDEX NO.: 520392/2023FIRST AMENDED
VERIFIED COMPLAINTTHE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD DETECTIVE MEJIA
(RETIRED), SHIELD NO. 05679, NYPD DETECTIVE
BRIAN GREAGIE, SHIELD NO. 2435, and NYPD
POLICE OFFICERS JOHN AND JANE DOES NUMBERS
1-10,**JURY TRIAL
DEMANDED**

Defendants.

----- X

Plaintiff, **RYAN SANTA**, by his attorneys, Shulman-Hill, PLLC, as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violations of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On January 19, 2022, at approximately 6:00 a.m., Plaintiff **RYAN SANTA**, while lawfully in the vicinity of 1354 63rd Street, County of Kings, State of New York, was subject to an unlawful arrest, and detention by defendant police officers for an incident that allegedly occurred on February 8, 2021, at approximately 2:58 a.m. inside 144 West 139th Street. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional, common law and statutory rights when the individual defendants unlawfully arrested, detained, passed along false accusations to prosecuting attorneys and engaged in the malicious prosecution of Plaintiff, in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York. Plaintiff was deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 8802 and his constitutional, common law and statutory rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped, detained, passed along false accusations to prosecuting attorneys and engaged in the malicious prosecution of Plaintiff, in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff, **RYAN SANTA**, is a resident of the state of New York.

3. NYPD Detective David Mejia (Retired), Shield No. 05679, (RETIRED) was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

4. NYPD Detective David Mejia (Retired), Shield No. 05679, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

5. Upon information and belief, NYPD Detective David Mejia (Retired), Shield No. 05679, was at all times relevant herein assigned to the NYPD 32nd Precinct.

6. NYPD Detective Brian Greaige, Shield No. 2435, was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

7. NYPD Detective Brian Greaige, Shield No. 2435, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

8. Upon information and belief, NYPD Detective Brian Greaige, Shield No. 2435, was at all times relevant herein assigned to the NYPD 32nd Precinct.

9. NYPD Police Officers John and Jane Does Numbers 1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

10. NYPD Police Officers John and Jane Does Numbers 1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

11. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

12. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

13. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the City of New York in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

14. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, Plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on April 13, 2023.

15. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and the City of New York has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

16. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

17. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

18. On January 19, 2022, at approximately 6:00 a.m., Plaintiff was lawfully in the vicinity of 1354 63rd Street, County of Kings, State of New York, when the defendant officers unlawfully detained and arrested Plaintiff without legal justification.

19. At the referenced place and time, the Plaintiff was present in his home with roommate, sleeping, when he heard loud banging on his front door.

20. Plaintiff then saw flashing lights on his fire escape and feared his residence was being broken into.

21. Defendant officers then rushed into Plaintiff's apartment, grabbed Plaintiff, detained him, and placed him under arrest.

22. Plaintiff was aggressively grabbed, handcuffed, removed, and thrown into a police vehicle despite the lack of lawful basis.

23. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officers have an objective credible basis to believe that Plaintiff was engaged in criminal conduct or had violated the law in any way.

24. At no point did Defendant Officers recover any illegal drugs, weapons, graffiti instruments, other illegal contraband, or evidence of a crime from Plaintiff's person or from a location that was in Plaintiff's possession, custody, or control.

25. Plaintiff did not resist arrest at any point.

26. The defendant officers arrested Plaintiff in the complete absence of probable cause and brought him to the 32nd Precinct in Manhattan.

27. Upon his arrival at the 32nd Precinct, Plaintiff was unlawfully searched, fingerprinted, photographed, and questioned before being lodged in a holding cell.

28. While in a holding cell, Plaintiff told defendant officers that he was in pain and required medical attention. He repeatedly informed the defendant officers that he was under the care of a doctor and required medication, but his pleas were ignored.

29. After approximately four (4) hours unlawfully in police custody at the precinct, Plaintiff was brought to New York County Central Booking.

30. While at Central Booking, Plaintiff continued to plead with officers for medical attention. In response, one defendant officer told him that he did not care if Plaintiff was “dying on the floor” before, with intent to demean, offend, and alarm him, directed Plaintiff to engage in a sexual act. Specifically, the defendant officer said to Plaintiff “suck my d*ck.”

31. This defendant officer then led Plaintiff to a closed room, where he put on latex gloves and proceeded to punch him about the face and chest, explaining that he talked “too much.”

32. Additional defendant officers within earshot of Plaintiff laughed as he shouted for help.

33. Finally, EMS was called and transported Plaintiff to a local hospital where he was treated for his injuries.

34. When Plaintiff was returned to Central Booking and arraigned, he was remanded to Rikers Island based on the false and inaccurate representations of the defendant officers.

35. As a result of the defendant officer’s false representations, Plaintiff would spend approximately three (3) months at Rikers Island before he was released.

36. Plaintiff was never indicted by a grand jury.

37. The false charges against Plaintiff were dismissed and sealed in their entirety on January 18, 2023.

38. Plaintiff continues to suffer severe emotional trauma and distress from the actions of defendant officers complained of above.

39. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of Plaintiff’s rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably assaulting, battering, and using excessive force against Plaintiff.

40. The unlawful arrest, malicious prosecution, assault, battery, and excessive use of force by the defendants caused Plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION**Negligence**

41. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

42. Defendants owed a duty of care to Plaintiff.

43. Defendant officer's breached that duty of care by deliberately restraining and injuring Plaintiff.

44. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, Defendant officers deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

45. All of the foregoing occurred without any fault or provocation by Plaintiff.

46. Defendants officers were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

47. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

48. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION**Unlawful Stop, Question, and Search**

49. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

50. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and grab employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

51. The conduct of defendants in approaching, stopping, and grabbing Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

52. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

53. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

54. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

**Violation of Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights:
Unlawful Seizure and Deprivation of Liberty**

55. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

56. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

57. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

False Imprisonment

58. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

59. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

60. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

61. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

62. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

63. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights:
Excessive Force**

64. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

65. The use of excessive force by defendants by, amongst other things, seizing and tightly handcuffing him, constituted objectively unreasonable physical seizures of Plaintiff in violation of his rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

66. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress**

67. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

68. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

69. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

70. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

71. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

72. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

73. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

74. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

75. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

76. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Failure to Intervene

77. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

78. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

79. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

80. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, his property was damaged, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

81. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

82. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

83. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

84. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries,

including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

**Violation of Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights:
Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process**

85. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

86. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the New York County District Attorney's Office.

87. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the New York County District Attorney's Office.

88. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the New York County District Attorney's Office.

89. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated Plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

90. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

91. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

92. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

93. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of Defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries including, but not limited to: economic, emotional, and psychological injuries.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution

94. The Plaintiffs repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

95. The acts and conduct of the Defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the United States Constitution.

96. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against Plaintiffs.

97. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against Plaintiffs and for each of the charges for which they were prosecuted.

98. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Assault

99. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

100. Defendants, their agents, servants, and employees, acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally, willfully, and maliciously assaulted Plaintiff in that they had the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff, that such acts caused apprehension of such contact in the Plaintiff.

101. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

102. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

103. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

104. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Battery

105. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

106. Defendants, their agents, servants, and employees, acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally, willfully, and maliciously battered Plaintiff when they, in a hostile and/or offensive manner, roughly grabbed the plaintiff, effecting an arrest of Plaintiff without his consent

involving excessively and unreasonably tight handcuffs, and with the intention of causing harmful and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff and caused such battery.

107. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

108. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

109. The City, as the employer of the defendant officers, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

110. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Individual Defendant Officers' Violations of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

111. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

112. The acts of the defendant officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom, or usage.

113. The acts of the defendant officers caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

114. The defendant officers, while in uniform, unlawfully seized, frisked, and searched Plaintiff, before detaining plaintiff and further causing his detention for approximately three (3) months in total.

115. By reason of the acts and omissions by defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Individual Defendant Officer's Failure to Intervene in Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

116. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

117. The acts of the defendant officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.

118. Defendant officers had a duty to protect Plaintiff from violations of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

119. The defendant officers that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's AC 8-802 right against unreasonable search and seizure and excessive force had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

120. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein, thereby failed in their duty to intervene to protect Plaintiff from violation of his rights.

121. By reason of the acts and omissions by defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

FIFTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

City-Employer's Liability for Defendant Officers' Violations of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

122. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

123. Defendant officers are "covered individuals," as defined in 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 - 801 in that they are employees of the Police Department or persons appointed by the Police Commissioner as a Special Patrolman.

124. The City of New York, as the employer of the covered individual defendant officers, is liable to the Plaintiff for the wrongdoing of the covered individual defendant officers.

125. The acts of the defendant officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.

126. The acts of defendant officers caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

127. The defendant officers, while in uniform, unlawfully seized, frisked, and searched the Plaintiff, before detaining plaintiff and further causing his detention for approximately three (3) months in total.

128. By reason of the acts and omissions by defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

SIXTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
**City-Employer's Liability for Defendant Officer's Failure to
Intervene in Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights**

129. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

130. Defendant officers are "covered individuals," as defined in 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 - 801 in that they are employees of the Police Department or persons appointed by the Police Commissioner as a Special Patrolman.

131. The City of New York, as the employer of the covered individual defendant officers, is liable to the Plaintiff for the wrongdoing of the covered individual defendant officers.

132. The acts of defendant officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.

133. Defendant officers had a duty to protect Plaintiff from violations of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

134. Defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's AC 8 – 802 rights against unreasonable search and seizure and excessive force had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

135. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein, thereby failed in their duty to intervene to protect Plaintiff from violation of his rights.

136. By reason of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured physical and emotional injuries and was otherwise damaged and injured.

SEVENTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Violation of Article I, § 12 of the New York State Constitution

137. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the above paragraphs with the same force and effect as if fully set forth herein.

138. Such conduct breached the protections guaranteed to plaintiff by the New York State Constitution, including but not limited to, Article 1, §§ 1, 6, 8, 9, 11, and 12, and including the following rights:

- i. freedom from unreasonable search and seizure of his person and property;
- ii. freedom from arrest without probable cause;
- iii. freedom from false imprisonment, that being wrongfully detained without good faith, reasonable suspicion, or legal justification, and of which wrongful detention plaintiff was aware and did not consent;
- iv. freedom from the lodging of false charges against him by police officers and prosecutors, including on information and belief, by some or all of the individual defendants; and
- v. freedom from deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

139. As a direct and proximate result of defendants' deprivations of Plaintiff's rights, privileges, and immunities guaranteed by the New York State Constitution, Plaintiff suffered physical, economic and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

140. As a result of the above tortious conduct, Plaintiff was caused to suffer physical, economic, and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

141. As a result of the above unconstitutional conduct, the City of New York is liable for the conduct of the individual defendants and any damages they caused under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

JURY DEMAND

142. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff, RYAN SANTA, demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law, and that the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988 and 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 801 *et seq.*.

Dated: New York, New York
July 17, 2023

By: 
Omar T. Russo, Esq.
Shulman-Hill, PLLC
Attorneys for Plaintiff
1 State Street Plaza, 15th Floor
New York, New York 10004
(212) 221-1000

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NEW YORK,
NEW YORK 10007

NYPD DETECTIVE DAVID MEJIA, Shield No. 05679, (RETIRED), 1 Police Plaza Path,
New York, NEW YORK 10038

NYPD DETECTIVE BRIAN GREAIKE, Shield No. 2435, Detective Squad, 32nd Precinct,
250 West 135th Street, New York, NEW YORK 10030

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

OMAR T. RUSSO, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am an associate of the law firm of **SHULMAN-HILL PLLC**, I have read the annexed **FIRST AMENDED VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters, I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein, I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
July 17, 2023

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Omar T. Russo", written in a cursive style.

OMAR T. RUSSO